

Chapter 190 - Part 1

Extra 12-1

When Gu Yixue returned home, it was already eleven o'clock.

Originally, she didn't need to come home.

Once a movie started filming, she was the type to stay on set, with sleeping time pitifully short, usually around three to four hours.

But today was an exception.

She didn't know if anyone still remembered—today was her birthday.

Probably no one remembered.

Who would remember an unimportant person's birthday?

She rarely told others about her birthday.

Not to mention many people disliked illegitimate daughters, even she herself disliked her own origins.

But sometimes heaven played tricks, and fate was occasionally unfair.

She couldn't choose her own birth.

On her birthday, her mother passed away.

Also on her birthday, she returned to the Gu family.

So she didn't like celebrating birthdays.

Everyone in the Gu family only remembered Gu Chunmian's birthday, holding extravagant birthday parties for Gu Chunmian's birthday.

Gu Chunmian would call friends together, becoming the focus of everyone's attention.

And she was just Gu Chunmian's foil.

Or rather, a reference point.

But what disappointed everyone was that Gu Yixue didn't grow up the way everyone expected.

Everyone hoped she would be mediocre and accomplish nothing, but she had a rebellious streak. Even as a Beta, she was no worse than any Alpha or Omega.

After entering the Gu family, she never learned how to hide her sharp edges.

Every exam, she did better than Gu Chunmian.

Even her appearance far surpassed Gu Chunmian's.

Everyone said she resembled her mother.

Because her mother had once been an extremely popular actress, but she happened to meet her father.

Gu Yixue didn't have many memories of her mother anymore.

She only remembered that she was very beautiful.

Even now, people would still mention her mother's film and television works, reminiscing about that era that once briefly belonged to her mother. But she always avoided it.

She was unwilling to hear anything related to her mother.

Yet she diligently fulfilled her mother's last wish.

Her mother wanted to enter the Gu family genealogy, wanted her to live in the Gu family without 争 or 抢¹.

So she did as told.

But her mother never said that the Gu family was a cage that devoured people without spitting out bones.

Gu Chunmian's mother was still alive, and every time she saw her, she looked as if she wanted to kill her.

Just being stared at by those eyes made Gu Yixue feel she couldn't eat.

Sometimes, she felt disgusted with herself.

Probably because she entered this industry, her ability to immerse herself was much stronger than others.

She would occasionally think, if she were Gu Chunmian's mother, what would she do?

Perhaps every day she spent in the Gu family, Mrs. Gu felt as if there was a fishbone stuck in her throat.

Even though she tried her best to yield to Gu Chunmian, and when young had carefully tried to please Gu Chunmian.

She never received a pleasant expression.

So at sixteen, she went abroad to study, and almost only returned once a year.

If possible, she wouldn't return even once.

Those days abroad were quite pleasant. Everyone only knew her as Quella, not as Gu Yixue.

Not as that illegitimate daughter of the Gu family who couldn't see the light.

Even so, the friends she made abroad were merely casual acquaintances.

Some became acquainted through talent, some through spending time together.

But when she returned to the country, she basically lost contact with them all.

However, Gu Yixue still came back today.

This was the second year of her marriage to Shen Fenghe, and the first birthday she was spending.

In previous years, she would occasionally receive a birthday greeting from Shen Fenghe right on time or late.

She didn't know if there would be one this year.

Gu Yixue often wondered, are people moths?

How could they keep doing things like flying into flames?

And enjoy it endlessly.

At least she was.

When it came to Shen Fenghe, she was willing to be a moth.

But reality still disappointed Gu Yixue.

Though the lights at home were on, it was the live-in housekeeper auntie, a deaf-mute person. She had just finished making a meal and was dozing at the dining table. Seeing Gu Yixue return, she immediately stood up and moved aside, then rubbed her eyes. After coming to her senses, she anxiously communicated with Gu Yixue in sign language: "Have you eaten? Let me heat it up for you."

Gu Yixue also replied in sign language: [No need, I'm tired, you should rest early.]

For Gu Yixue and Shen Fenghe, employing a deaf-mute auntie wasn't inconvenient.

Because both she and Shen Fenghe knew sign language.

The reason was that when she was twelve, she went out with Gu Chunmian, and Gu Chunmian seemed to be making a bet with friends. She used a slingshot to shoot directly at her, hitting her ear bone.

Because her ear couldn't hear, she was also unwilling to communicate with people.

She became a deaf-mute for a very long time.

During that time, Shen Fenghe often came to see her, often took her out to play.

And learned sign language.

Shen Fenghe was someone who learned everything very quickly.

Gu Chunmian really disliked Shen Fenghe playing with her, but Shen Fenghe had a strong personality and was equally cold to everyone. Even though Gu Chunmian might be her fiancée, she never listened to Gu Chunmian.

This was also one of the reasons Gu Chunmian disliked Shen Fenghe.

Footnotes:

¹ 争 or 抢 (zhēng or qiǎng) - To compete or fight for something; the phrase means to live without 争ing (competing/争ling) or 抢ing (snatching/fighting for things)